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★★★★ \$5.00

DJIA 49412.40 ▲ 313.69 0.64% NASDAQ 23601.36 ▲ 0.4% STOXX 600 609.57 ▲ 0.2% 10-YR. TREAS. ▲ 6/32, yield 4.212% OIL \$60.63 ▼ \$0.44 GOLD \$5,079.70 ▲ \$103.50 EURO \$1.1883 YEN 154.20

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **A surge in gold's price** that carried it past the \$5,000-an-ounce barrier to settle above it on Monday has boosted mining companies' profits, encouraged them to restart old mines, expand existing operations and develop new projects. **A1, B1, B9**

◆ **U.S. stocks powered** through geopolitical concerns to lift the S&P 500, Dow and Nasdaq by 0.5%, 0.6% and 0.4%, respectively. **B10**

◆ **Quantum-computing** company IonQ struck a deal to buy chip maker SkyWater Technology for \$35 a share, or roughly \$1.8 billion. **B1**

◆ **Nvidia said it is** simplifying the tracking of changes in the weather and climate with a new suite of open-source artificial-intelligence models. **B1**

◆ **Nvidia invested** \$2 billion in CoreWeave and the companies announced a collaboration to build new AI factories. **B4**

◆ **The EU undertook** an investigation into Elon Musk's X following a public outcry over sexualized deepfake images created by the company's Grok AI service. **B4**

◆ **The chairman of the** Senate's antitrust subcommittee voiced concerns about Netflix's proposed acquisition of the Warner Bros. movie and TV studios and HBO Max streaming service. **B3**

◆ **Bankrupt auto-parts** supplier First Brands is shutting down parts of its North American business after top lenders resisted providing additional funding to keep it afloat. **B3**

◆ **The Treasury Department** canceled all of its contracts with consulting firm Booz Allen Hamilton amid the administration's cuts to government-contract funding. **B3**

Worldwide

◆ **Trump signaled** that he is willing to wind down a massive immigration enforcement effort in Minnesota amid backlash over aggressive tactics that have left two U.S. citizens in the state dead. **A1, A4**

◆ **Monthly health-insurance** bills are rising for millions of Americans, putting new pressure on a nation frustrated by the high cost of living. **A1**

◆ **The Trump administration** is proposing roughly flat rates for Medicare insurers next year, an update that falls well short of Wall Street expectations. **A2**

◆ **U.S. trading partners,** feeling burned by an unpredictable White House, are reassessing China in a drive to lessen their longstanding reliance on Washington. **A7**

◆ **The U.S. will raise tariffs** on South Korea to 25% from 15%, Trump said, insisting that Seoul hadn't moved fast enough to implement a trade pact the two nations arrived at last year. **A7**

◆ **Rights groups said** they are uncovering evidence that the death toll from Iran's suppression of antigovernment protests is far higher than first thought, with some projecting it will exceed 10,000. **A6**

◆ **The USS Abraham Lincoln** carrier group entered the Middle East, giving Trump additional offensive and defensive capabilities should he choose to attack Iran. **A6**

◆ **A global crackdown** on human traffickers and smugglers coordinated by Interpol led to the arrest of more than 3,700 suspects and aided more than 4,400 potential victims, the organization said. **A7**

CONTENTS	Markets Digest.....	B6
Arts in Review.....	Opinion.....	A13-15
Business & Finance B2-3	Personal Journal A10-11	
Crossword.....	Sports.....	A16
From Page One.....	Technology.....	B4
Heard on Street.....	U.S. News.....	A2-4
Markets.....	World News.....	A6-8



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U.S. Digs Out From Monster Winter Storm



JOSEPH PREZIOSO/AGENCE FRANCE PRESSE/GETTY IMAGES

SNOW SLAM: People shoveled Monday in Boston, where over 17 inches of snow fell in the weekend storm that had nearly 200 million Americans under weather warnings. More than 710,000 households from Texas to Maine were still without power. **A3**

Health-Insurance Costs Surge, Can Rival Mortgage Expenses

Middle-income earners who rely on Obamacare see monthly bills soar

By RACHEL LOUISE ENSIGN

Millions of people across the U.S. are starting to see their monthly health-insurance bills rise, a new pressure point for a nation still frustrated with the high cost of living.

Many of those facing the most dramatic dollar increases are middle-income

earners who buy health insurance through the marketplaces set up by the government's Affordable Care Act, known as Obamacare.

Expanded subsidies for those insured under the ACA expired on Dec. 31—the central battle in last year's record-long government shutdown. That shutdown ended with no resolution on the subsidies, and lawmakers haven't passed legislation to revive them.

Now, the newly calculated insurance bills are coming due, and people are having to figure out how to pay up, or

go without.

Lenny and Mande Wilson, who are 47 years old and live in Charleston, W.Va., paid \$255 a month last year for a low-end ACA plan. Late last year, they learned their bill would be going up to \$2,155 a month, a sum nearly triple their monthly mortgage payment of about \$760.

The Wilsons each squeezed in one last checkup before the end of 2025 and are now going without insurance. They are planning to put the money they used to spend on their premiums into an emergency

fund. They will avoid any preventive care and hope their modest savings can cover any medical costs.

Their ACA insurance wasn't "the greatest plan, but it gave us some coverage and made sure we wouldn't go bankrupt if something happened," said Lenny Wilson, who co-owns an IT business. His wife, Mande Wilson, makes pottery.

Living without health insurance
Please turn to page A2

◆ **Flat rates offered to Medicare insurers.....** **A2**

INSIDE



MOTI MILROD/REUTERS

WORLD NEWS
Israel to reopen Gaza border crossing as last hostage's remains are found. **A6**



LANIA ARSLAN FOR WSJ

BUSINESS & FINANCE
What's changed at Starbucks—and what its new CEO has next on his list. **B1**

The American City at War With the U.S. Government

The showdown between federal and local authorities in Minneapolis makes even some Trump supporters uneasy

By JOSHUA CHAFFIN AND MICHELLE HACKMAN

MINNEAPOLIS—For months, Jacob Frey, the Minneapolis mayor, felt a growing dread watching the number of federal immigration and Border Patrol agents swell from dozens to hundreds to thousands, all deployed to his city to carry out President Trump's promise of the largest deportation of illegal immigrants in American history.

"We've seen constant, constant, escalation," Frey said. "The [police] chief and I were both publicly and privately expressing deep concern of the possibility, even likelihood, that somebody was going to get seri-

ously injured or killed."

Then Renee Good, a 37-year-old mother, was fatally shot in the head on Jan. 7 by an Immigration and Customs Enforcement agent during one of the many protests erupting in the city against the actions of federal agents.

On Saturday, it happened again.

Alex Pretti, a 37-year-old nurse at the Minneapolis VA Medical Center, was shot with 10 rounds and killed by a Border Patrol agent after a group of officers wrestled him to the frozen ground in front of a doughnut shop where he died.

Please turn to page A9

No Squeaking From This Secret Society

* * *
Only a handful of people have seen WD-40's formula

By JENNIFER WILLIAMS

There's a club in San Diego that's perhaps more exclusive than Soho House and harder to get into than some of the most elite colleges in the country.

It requires a special key, nondisclosure agreements, passage through a bank vault and, typically, an executive title. The drinks don't flow, members don't rub elbows with notable people and chefs aren't filling plates with tasty bites. The only perk is knowing the secrets of the world's most famous lubricant. And yet, for those in the know, there's no greater privilege.

Please turn to page A9

Gold Miners Ramp Up As Prices Hit Milestone

By ALEXANDRA WEXLER

JOHANNESBURG—For years, hundreds of illegal miners known locally as zama zamas prospected for gold on a patch of land on the outskirts of the city with hammers and chisels in hand-dug tunnels.

Now, the site has been transformed into South Africa's first new underground gold mine in more than 15 years, part of a global rush to boost production of a metal trading at record prices.

"It looked like a Mad Max movie," said Rudi Deyzel, chief executive of West Wits Mining, the Australian company that owns the mine. "I had to crawl on my stomach to go in there."

Around \$100 million of investment is pouring into the mine, where workers now sport hard hats, carry emergency breathing devices and use advanced drills and other equipment. The project, called Qala Shallows, recovered its

first gold in October and is estimated to produce more than \$4.5 billion of the metal at current market prices.

Gold settled above \$5,000 for the first time on Monday, driven by heightened geopolitical concerns among other factors. The precious metal has more than doubled in value in less than two years. Silver, meanwhile, leapt 14% to \$115.50 Monday.

The surge has boosted profits for mining companies around the globe, encouraging them to restart old mines, expand existing operations and develop new projects. Global gold-exploration budgets increased 11% to \$6.15 billion in 2025, according to S&P Global Energy.

Newmont, the world's No. 1
Please turn to page A8

◆ **Gold soars past \$5,000 for first time.....** **B1**
◆ **Hong Kong's Zijin buys Allied Gold for \$4.01 billion.....** **B9**

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